On my final afternoon, I overhear a newly-arrived American tourist exclaim at a temple, ‘Holy shit! WTF is going on here?’ He has hired a tour guide and I feel sorry for him. I grab a beer at a cafe with a view of the temples and ponder how, if I were a guide, would I convey that the erotic art of Khajuraho is a brilliant chapter in the history of Indian art and sculpture, and ought to be a perennial reminder to not buy into simplistic narratives about our past or the present.